

100 Days of Linux - Day 094

Title: Command-Line Arguments in Bash Scripts

Today's Goal

Learn how to pass values to a Bash script using command-line arguments.

Why This Matters

Most real-world Bash scripts accept arguments so they can perform different tasks without modifying the script.

Commands of the Day

Syntax:

`./script.sh arg1 arg2`

`$0` (script name)

`$1` (first argument)

`$2` (second argument)

`##` (number of arguments)

`$@` (all arguments)

Beginner Lesson

Command-line arguments are values supplied when running a script. Inside the script, use special variables such as `$1` and `$2` to access them. This makes scripts reusable and flexible.

Practice Questions

1. Create a script named `arguments.sh`.
2. Print the script name using `$0`.
3. Print the first and second arguments using `$1` and `$2`.
4. Display the total number of arguments using `##`.
5. Run the script with your name and city as arguments.

Hints

Run the script as `./arguments.sh Vishal Bangalore` and observe how the values change.

Mini Challenge

Create a script that accepts three arguments: project name, environment and version, then prints a formatted summary.

Common Mistakes

Running the script without arguments, confusing `$0` with `$1`, or forgetting to make the script executable.

Did You Know?

Many Linux utilities internally process command-line arguments in the same way your Bash scripts do.

Pro Tip

Always validate the number of arguments before using them in larger scripts.

Answer Key (Instructor Only)

Q1: `nano arguments.sh`

Q2: `echo $0`

Q3: `echo $1` and `echo $2`

Q4: `echo ##`

Q5: `./arguments.sh Vishal Bangalore`

Homework

Write a script that accepts your name, favourite language and city as arguments, then displays them in a sentence.

Next Day Preview

Tomorrow you'll learn how to use `if`, `elif` and `else` statements in Bash scripts.